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This paper serves as the documentation of the development of a Greek XLE grammar. Greek is a SVO and pro-drop language, with synthetic morphology. Relative clauses in Greek are classified as nominal or adverbial, that is, modifying nouns or verbs. In my project, I focus on the nominal ones and especially on the supplementary type, which adds extra, omittable information and is enclosed in commas (contrary to the restrictive type). Relative clauses are introduced in two ways: either with a simple relativizer (*poy*, namely a *that* complementizer) or with relative pronouns (*o opoios* / *h opoia* / *to opoio*, composite elements consisting of the definite article and a following pronominal element that is inflected like an adjective), which need to be in gender, number and case agreement with their antecedent.

First, I defined my sentence S as a combination of NP and VP, with the subject always being in nominative case and the object being in accusative. I created templates for pronouns, adjectives and all valency types of verbs. The remaining items in the lexicon are explicitly marked with (^ PRED), (^ DEF), (^N-TYPE), (^NUM), (^ PERS), (^GEND), (^CASE). Verbs get the attributes (^MOOD) and (^TENSE). All nouns, proper nouns and relative pronouns must be preceded by a determiner, in contrast to personal pronouns (*aytos* / *ayth* / *ayto*) and predicative adjectives (eg. *to skyli einai koyrasmeno* = ‘**the** dog is tired’). Attributive adjectives, however, appear after a determiner and before the noun they modify, like in English (eg. *to koyrasmeno skyli* = ‘**the** tired dog’). Subject complements after copula verbs retain their nominative case (as above, eg. *to skyli-NOM einai koyrasmeno-NOM* = ‘**the** dog-NOM is tired-NOM’). All these rules are reflected in my XLE subcategorization rules. Relative clauses are optional inside NPs, making it possible to appear at any sentence position, given that they

follow any noun or personal pronoun. Sentences like (10) showcase this possibility. In the F-structure, relative clauses (as well as attributive adjectives) are labeled as adjuncts.

The relative pronouns are the subject of the embedded clause, unless they are in accusative case. Pronouns agree with all ϕ -features of the NP they modify – in any other scenario, the derivation crashes (eg. see sentence (4), where determiners, adjective and pronoun have the feminine marker in order to agree with the feminine noun *mhtera* = ‘mother’, in contrast to sentence (12)). The relativizer *poy* replaces all inflected relative pronouns no matter their grammatical relation to the (transitive or intransitive) embedded verb (see sentences (2), (3), (4), as well as (10) and (11)). The grammar I have developed does not tackle pro-drop and thus, all my testfile sentences have an overt subject. In sentences (7) and (8), the relative pronoun in accusative case modifies the noun and the personal pronoun respectively, having the meaning of ‘whom’ in the subordinate clause. Unlike English, Greek does not differentiate between human or non-human antecedent, so sentence (10) employs the relative pronoun *to opoio* which means ‘who/whom’ but it is translated as ‘which’.

A great deal of ambiguity in Greek stems from the syncretism in the noun and pronoun paradigms. It is very common for the nominative and accusative case to have the same surface form, especially for the neuter grammatical gender. This is why, in sentence (6), the XLE grammar presents two possible solutions. *To opoio* can appear both as a nominative and accusative relative pronoun, making it suitable for either subject or object of the embedded clause. In my grammar, it would be enough to modify the subcategorization rules and make it impossible for the pronoun to be the object when there is no other argument in nominative case to be the subject. Nevertheless, in practice, it remains an ambiguous, albeit grammatical, sentence due to pro-drop.

The major issue I was not able to solve was the representation of relativizer *poy*. In reality, this is an uninflected element which holds no grammatical relation to the embedded

verb and, instead, links it with its nearer noun in the matrix clause. This involves subject/object control that falls outside the scope of my project. As a heuristic, *poy* is defined as a relative pronoun in nominative case and so, the derivation does not crash. For this reason- *poy* being always marked with nominative case in my grammar - I could not replace *thn opoia* (relative pronoun in accusative case) with *poy* in a sentence like (8), even though it would be perfectly grammatical in spoken Greek.

Overall, the present grammar deals successfully with monovalent and divalent verbs (including the copula *be*), noun substitution by personal pronouns, ϕ -feature agreement between determiners, (proper) nouns and pronouns, verbal agreement, attributive and predicative adjectives, relative clauses that modify matrix subjects, relative clauses that modify matrix objects, relative pronouns as subject of the subordinate clause, relative pronouns as object of the subordinate clause and punctuation.

Appendix

All glosses follow the Leipzig rules (as revised in 2015)

#1

h mhtera koima-tai.

the-F.NOM.SG mother-NOM sleep-s-3SG.PRS

‘The mother sleeps’

#2

h mhtera, poy einai koyrasmen-h, koima-tai.

the-F.NOM.SG mother-NOM that is-3SG.PRS tired-F.NOM.SG sleep-s-3SG.PRS

‘The mother, that is tired, sleeps.’

3

ayt-h, h opoi-a einai

she-F.NOM.SG the-F.NOM.SG who-F.NOM.SG is-3SG.PRS

koyrasmen-h, koima-tai.

tired-F.NOM.SG sleep-s-3SG.PRS

‘She, who is tired, sleeps’

4

h mhtera, h opoi-a

the-F.NOM.SG mother- NOM the-F.NOM.SG who-F.NOM.SG

koima-tai, einai koyrasmen-h.

sleep-s-3SG.PRS is-3SG.PRS tired-F.NOM.SG

‘The mother, who sleeps, is tired’

5

o Petros xaide-pse to kafe skyli.
the- M.NOM.SG Peter-NOM pet-ted-3SG.PST the-N.ACC.SG brown-N.ACC.SG dog-
ACC

‘Peter petted the brown dog’

6

o Petros xaide- pse to skyli,
the- M.NOM.SG Peter-NOM pet-ted-3SG.PST the-N.ACC.SG dog-ACC
to opoi-o einai peinasmen-o.
the-N.NOM.SG who-N.NOM.SG is-3SG.PRS hungry- N.NOM.SG

‘Peter petted the dog, which is hungry’

7

h mhtera agkalia-se to-n Petro,
the-F.NOM.SG mother-NOM hug-ged-3SG.PST the-M.ACC.SG Peter-ACC
to-n opoi-o ayt-h agapa-ei.
the- M.ACC.SG who-M.ACC.SG she-F.NOM.SG love-s-3SG.PRS

‘The mother hugged Peter, whom she loves’

8

o Petros agkalia-se ayt-hn, thn
the-M.NOM.SG Peter-NOM hug-ged-3SG.PST her-F.ACC.SG the-F.ACC.SG
opoi-a ayt-os agapa-ei.

who-F.ACC.SG he-M.NOM.SG love-s-3SG.PRS

‘Peter hugged her, whom he loves’

9

o Petros, poy einai filozw-os,
the-M.NOM.SG Peter-NOM that is-3SG.PRS animal.lover-M.NOM.SG
xaide-pse to skyli.
pet-ted-3SG.PST the-N.ACC.SG dog-ACC.SG

‘Peter, that loves animals, petted the dog.’

10

o Petros, poy einai filozw-os,
the-M.NOM.SG Peter-NOM that is-3SG.PRS animal.lover-M.NOM.SG
xaide-pse to skyli, to opoi-o
pet-ted-3SG.PST the-N.ACC.SG dog-ACC.SG the-N.ACC.SG who-N.ACC.SG
ayt-os yiothet-ise.
he-M.NOM.SG adopt-ed-3SG-PST

‘Peter, that loves animals, petted the dog, which he adopted’

11

o Petros, o opoio-s einai
the-M.NOM.SG Peter-NOM the-M.NOM.SG who-M.NOM.SG is-3SG.PRS
filozw-os, xaide-pse ayt-o, poy ex-ei
animal.lover-M.NOM.SG pet-ted-3SG.PST it-N.ACC.SG that has-3SG.PRS
kafe trixwma.

brown-N.ACC.SG fur-ACC

‘Peter, who loves animals, petted it, that has brown fur’

12 - gender agreement violation between determiner and relative pronoun

*h mhtera, to opoia einai
the-F.NOM.SG mother-NOM the-N.NOM.SG who-F.NOM.SG is-3SG.PRS
koyrasmen-h, koima-tai.
tired-F.NOM.SG sleep-s-3SG.PRS
‘The mother, who is tired, sleeps’

13 - gender agreement violation between proper noun and determiner/pronoun/adjective

*to Petros, o opoi-o einai
the-N.NOM.SG Peter-NOM the-M.NOM.SG who-N.NOM.SG is-3SG.PRS
filozw-o, koima-tai
animal.lover-N.NOM.SG sleep-s-3SG.PRS
‘Peter, who loves animals, sleeps’

14 - case violation: object in nominative (its relative pronoun in accusative)

*h mhtera agkaliase o Petros,
the-F.NOM.SG mother-NOM hug-ged-3SG.PST the-M.NOM.SG Peter-NOM
to-n opoi-o ayt-h agapa-ei.
the- M.ACC.SG who-M.ACC.SG she-F.NOM.SG love-s-3SG.PRS
‘The mother hugged Peter, whom she loves’

15 - case violation: relative pronoun in nominative

*o Petros agkaliase aythn, h
the-M.NOM.SG Peter-NOM hug-ged-3SG.PST her-F.ACC.SG the-F.NOM.SG
opoia aytos agapa-ei.
who-F.NOM.SG he-M.NOM.SG love-s-3SG.PRS
'Peter hugged her, whom he loves'

16 - transitive verb without object

*o Petros agkalia-se.
the-M.NOM.SG Peter-NOM hug-ged-3SG.PST
'Peter hugged'

#17 - intransitive with object

*h mhtera koima-tai to skyli.
the-F.NOM.SG mother-NOM sleep-s-3SG.PRS the-N.ACC.SG dog-ACC
'The mother sleeps the dog'

#18 – noun and pronoun without determiner

*skyli, opoio einai peinasmeno, agapaei Petro.
dog-NOM who-N.NOM.SG is-3SG.PRS hungry- N.NOM.SG love-s-3SG.PRS Peter-ACC
'The dog, which is hungry, loves Peter'